

SHE'S THE VIBE



A GILDED LIBRARY FOR THE STORIES YOU KEEP

READING VIBE

A BOOK LOVER'S LIBRARY, REVIEW & REFLECTION JOURNAL

TRACK THE STORIES | KEEP THE FEELINGS | REMEMBER WHAT CHANGED YOU

Your reading life deserves somewhere beautiful to live.

This journal belongs to

A private library for your reading life.



NAME OR READER NAME

Use any name that feels like yours.

WHAT I WANT READING TO GIVE ME

Comfort, challenge, escape, knowledge, craft, connection, delight, or something else.

MY CURRENT READING SEASON

Describe your time, energy, attention, access, and appetite without judgment.

Welcome to Reading Vibe



Use the master journal for your whole reading life and the separate reflection pack for individual books.

Reading is not a performance. Audiobooks count. Graphic novels count. Rereads count. Pausing and not finishing count as choices.

MY INTENTION

What would make this journal worth returning to?

WHAT I DO NOT WANT THIS TO BECOME

Pressure, competition, consumerism, homework, another abandoned perfect system...

MY PERMISSION

Finish: I am allowed to read...

Choose your reading path



Move between light tracking and deeper analysis whenever you want.

QUICK VIBE

- ☐ Log a finished book
- ☐ Rate the feeling
- ☐ Track a series
- ☐ Pick by mood
- ☐ Play a challenge

DEEP DIVE

- ☐ Study craft
- ☐ Explore themes
- ☐ Question perspective
- ☐ Prepare for discussion
- ☐ Connect books

WHERE I WANT TO BEGIN

Name the section, book, goal, or mood that has your attention.

My reading identity



Your taste is allowed to be specific, contradictory, serious, silly, changing, and entirely yours.

I BECAME A READER WHEN

A book, person, place, school year, library, screen, fandom, or season.

I REACH FOR STORIES THAT

What patterns reliably pull you in?

I WANT TO BECOME MORE CURIOUS ABOUT

A genre, culture, form, period, subject, author, or way of reading.

WHAT I NEVER NEED TO PROVE

Release the imaginary reading police.

Genre map



Check what you love, avoid, want to try, or read only in a very specific mood.

FICTION

- ☐ Romance
- ☐ Fantasy
- ☐ Science fiction
- ☐ Mystery / thriller
- ☐ Historical fiction
- ☐ Horror

MORE WORLDS

- ☐ Literary fiction
- ☐ Poetry
- ☐ Memoir
- ☐ History
- ☐ Science / nature
- ☐ Essays / criticism

MY MISSING GENRES

Add subgenres, blended genres, niche interests, and categories the lists missed.

How I like to read



Design a reading life around what actually supports attention and pleasure.

FORMATS THAT WORK FOR ME

Print, ebook, audiobook, graphic, serialized, read-aloud, mixed formats.

ENVIRONMENTS THAT HELP

Lighting, noise, music, movement, time, seating, snacks, company.

WHAT INTERRUPTS OR DRAINS ME

Name practical barriers without turning them into character flaws.

A REALISTIC READING RHYTHM

What fits this season of life?

Books that made me



Some books entertain us. Some become part of our language for living.

A CHILDHOOD BOOK

What did it give younger you?

A BOOK THAT CHANGED MY MIND

What shifted?

A BOOK THAT FOUND ME AT THE RIGHT TIME

What made the timing matter?

A BOOK I HAVE OUTGROWN

Honor what it once gave you and what changed.

My reader moodboard



Create a visual language for your reading life.

Add colors, textures, shelves, settings, genres, fictional objects, library cards, snacks, weather, outfits, and tiny symbols.

My reading values



Goals help most when they serve values instead of replacing them.

WHAT I VALUE IN STORIES

Truth, beauty, surprise, comfort, representation, craft, challenge, wonder, usefulness.

HOW I WANT TO CHOOSE BOOKS

Mood, trusted people, curiosity, research, syllabus, library availability, serendipity.

HOW I WANT TO TALK ABOUT BOOKS

Honesty, generosity, critique, context, accessibility, room for disagreement.

PART ONE

My personal library

A library is not just what you own. It is what you can find, revisit, share, and remember.

INSIDE THIS PART

- Catalog physical, digital, and audio books
- Track series and special editions
- Remember what is lent or borrowed
- Notice the unread books already waiting



Personal Library Catalog 1



Use one page per shelf, format, genre, room, or alphabetical range.

TITLE	AUTHOR	FORMAT	STATUS	SHELF / FILE

Personal Library Catalog 2



Use one page per shelf, format, genre, room, or alphabetical range.

TITLE	AUTHOR	FORMAT	STATUS	SHELF / FILE

Personal Library Catalog 3



Use one page per shelf, format, genre, room, or alphabetical range.

TITLE	AUTHOR	FORMAT	STATUS	SHELF / FILE

Personal Library Catalog 4



Use one page per shelf, format, genre, room, or alphabetical range.

TITLE	AUTHOR	FORMAT	STATUS	SHELF / FILE

Series Shelf



Track order, ownership, progress, and the volume you need next.

SERIES	AUTHOR	OWNED	READ	NEXT / MISSING

Special Editions + Collectibles



Keep notes on signed books, sprayed edges, rare editions, boxed sets, and sentimental copies.

BOOK / SET	EDITION	SOURCE	VALUE TO ME

Lent + Borrowed



Books deserve a route home - including yours.

BOOK	PERSON / LIBRARY	OUT / DUE	RETURNED	NOTES

The DNF Shelf



Not finishing is information, not failure.

BOOK	STOPPED AT	WHY	TRY AGAIN?	DATE

Unread Books I Already Own



A gentle inventory before the next book haul.

TITLE	AUTHOR	WHY I BOUGHT IT	MOOD

PART TWO

TBR headquarters

A to-be-read list should invite you toward books, not stand over you with a clipboard.

INSIDE THIS PART

- Build a master TBR
- Choose by mood and season
- Track releases, holds, and wishlists
- Keep buying intentional without killing delight



Master TBR 1



Add the source so you remember why the book caught you.

TITLE	AUTHOR	WHY / SOURCE	PRIORITY	FORMAT

Master TBR 2



Add the source so you remember why the book caught you.

TITLE	AUTHOR	WHY / SOURCE	PRIORITY	FORMAT

Master TBR 3



Add the source so you remember why the book caught you.

TITLE	AUTHOR	WHY / SOURCE	PRIORITY	FORMAT

Master TBR 4



Add the source so you remember why the book caught you.

TITLE	AUTHOR	WHY / SOURCE	PRIORITY	FORMAT

Mood-Based TBR



Choose the feeling before forcing the title.

WHEN I WANT

- ☐ Comfort
- ☐ Adventure
- ☐ Romance
- ☐ A good cry
- ☐ A mystery
- ☐ Beautiful writing

WHEN I NEED

- ☐ Something short
- ☐ An audiobook
- ☐ Low stakes
- ☐ A challenge
- ☐ A new perspective
- ☐ Pure chaos

MY MOOD MATCHES

Add your favorite hyper-specific moods: rainy gothic mansion, competent women solving things, yearning in space...

Seasonal Reading



Build flexible stacks around weather, traditions, school terms, holidays, travel, and emotional seasons.

SPRING STACK

What feels like beginning, rain, softness, growth, or change?

SUMMER STACK

Heat, adventure, travel, romance, nostalgia, or pure fun.

AUTUMN STACK

Atmosphere, school energy, mystery, history, magic, or reflection.

WINTER STACK

Comfort, darkness, family, faith, snow, survival, or rest.

Upcoming Releases

Keep dates, formats, and preorder or library plans in one place.



TITLE	AUTHOR	RELEASE	FORMAT	PLAN

Book Wishlist



Separate wanting a book from needing to buy it today.

TITLE	EDITION	WHERE	PRICE	WHY I WANT IT

Library Holds + Requests



Track holds, interlibrary loans, waitlists, and pickup windows.

TITLE	LIBRARY	PLACED	POSITION	PICKUP / DUE

An intentional book budget



A planning page, not a rulebook. Libraries, swaps, gifts, used books, and not buying are all valid.

WHAT I COMFORTABLY WANT TO SPEND

Choose a month, season, trip, event, or no-spend period.

WHAT I WANT TO PRIORITIZE

Authors, local stores, formats, accessibility, special editions, gifts, or using what I own.

MY PAUSE-BEFORE-BUYING QUESTIONS

Do I have access elsewhere? Do I want this edition? Will I read it soon? Is this joy or pressure?

PART THREE

The reading log

Track enough to remember your life with books. Leave the rest unmeasured.

INSIDE THIS PART

- Set a humane reading intention
- Keep monthly overviews
- Track formats, rereads, and unfinished books
- Notice patterns without turning pleasure into productivity



My reading year



Let goals support curiosity instead of becoming a scorecard.

A NUMBER - IF NUMBERS MOTIVATE ME

Books, pages, hours, series, or no numeric goal.

A QUALITY I WANT MORE OF

Slower, wider, deeper, more playful, more communal, more diverse, more comforting.

A READING RISK I WANT TO TAKE

An intimidating book, unfamiliar form, translated work, classic, long series, or writing outside my usual lens.

WHAT SUCCESS WILL ACTUALLY MEAN

Describe the life, not only the total.

Month 1: January



A spacious overview for plans, actual reading, and the stories that stayed.

READING INTENTION

What would make this month satisfying?

PRIORITY BOOKS

Choose a few; this is not a contract.

BOOKS FINISHED

Titles, formats, and dates.

IN PROGRESS / PAUSED

Include holds, DNF, and mood changes.

MONTHLY FAVORITE + WHY

Name the feeling, craft, idea, or moment.

Month 2: February



A spacious overview for plans, actual reading, and the stories that stayed.

READING INTENTION

What would make this month satisfying?

PRIORITY BOOKS

Choose a few; this is not a contract.

BOOKS FINISHED

Titles, formats, and dates.

IN PROGRESS / PAUSED

Include holds, DNF, and mood changes.

MONTHLY FAVORITE + WHY

Name the feeling, craft, idea, or moment.

Month 3: March



A spacious overview for plans, actual reading, and the stories that stayed.

READING INTENTION

What would make this month satisfying?

PRIORITY BOOKS

Choose a few; this is not a contract.

BOOKS FINISHED

Titles, formats, and dates.

IN PROGRESS / PAUSED

Include holds, DNF, and mood changes.

MONTHLY FAVORITE + WHY

Name the feeling, craft, idea, or moment.

Month 4: April



A spacious overview for plans, actual reading, and the stories that stayed.

READING INTENTION

What would make this month satisfying?

PRIORITY BOOKS

Choose a few; this is not a contract.

BOOKS FINISHED

Titles, formats, and dates.

IN PROGRESS / PAUSED

Include holds, DNF, and mood changes.

MONTHLY FAVORITE + WHY

Name the feeling, craft, idea, or moment.

Month 5: May



A spacious overview for plans, actual reading, and the stories that stayed.

READING INTENTION

What would make this month satisfying?

PRIORITY BOOKS

Choose a few; this is not a contract.

BOOKS FINISHED

Titles, formats, and dates.

IN PROGRESS / PAUSED

Include holds, DNF, and mood changes.

MONTHLY FAVORITE + WHY

Name the feeling, craft, idea, or moment.

Month 6: June



A spacious overview for plans, actual reading, and the stories that stayed.

READING INTENTION

What would make this month satisfying?

PRIORITY BOOKS

Choose a few; this is not a contract.

BOOKS FINISHED

Titles, formats, and dates.

IN PROGRESS / PAUSED

Include holds, DNF, and mood changes.

MONTHLY FAVORITE + WHY

Name the feeling, craft, idea, or moment.

Month 7: July



A spacious overview for plans, actual reading, and the stories that stayed.

READING INTENTION

What would make this month satisfying?

PRIORITY BOOKS

Choose a few; this is not a contract.

BOOKS FINISHED

Titles, formats, and dates.

IN PROGRESS / PAUSED

Include holds, DNF, and mood changes.

MONTHLY FAVORITE + WHY

Name the feeling, craft, idea, or moment.

Month 8: August



A spacious overview for plans, actual reading, and the stories that stayed.

READING INTENTION

What would make this month satisfying?

PRIORITY BOOKS

Choose a few; this is not a contract.

BOOKS FINISHED

Titles, formats, and dates.

IN PROGRESS / PAUSED

Include holds, DNF, and mood changes.

MONTHLY FAVORITE + WHY

Name the feeling, craft, idea, or moment.

Month 9: September



A spacious overview for plans, actual reading, and the stories that stayed.

READING INTENTION

What would make this month satisfying?

PRIORITY BOOKS

Choose a few; this is not a contract.

BOOKS FINISHED

Titles, formats, and dates.

IN PROGRESS / PAUSED

Include holds, DNF, and mood changes.

MONTHLY FAVORITE + WHY

Name the feeling, craft, idea, or moment.

Month 10: October



A spacious overview for plans, actual reading, and the stories that stayed.

READING INTENTION

What would make this month satisfying?

PRIORITY BOOKS

Choose a few; this is not a contract.

BOOKS FINISHED

Titles, formats, and dates.

IN PROGRESS / PAUSED

Include holds, DNF, and mood changes.

MONTHLY FAVORITE + WHY

Name the feeling, craft, idea, or moment.

Month 11: November



A spacious overview for plans, actual reading, and the stories that stayed.

READING INTENTION

What would make this month satisfying?

PRIORITY BOOKS

Choose a few; this is not a contract.

BOOKS FINISHED

Titles, formats, and dates.

IN PROGRESS / PAUSED

Include holds, DNF, and mood changes.

MONTHLY FAVORITE + WHY

Name the feeling, craft, idea, or moment.

Month 12: December



A spacious overview for plans, actual reading, and the stories that stayed.

READING INTENTION

What would make this month satisfying?

PRIORITY BOOKS

Choose a few; this is not a contract.

BOOKS FINISHED

Titles, formats, and dates.

IN PROGRESS / PAUSED

Include holds, DNF, and mood changes.

MONTHLY FAVORITE + WHY

Name the feeling, craft, idea, or moment.

Format + Access Tracker



See how you are actually reading and where access is easiest.

BOOK	PRINT	EBOOK	AUDIO	LIBRARY	OWNED / OTHER

Rereads



A reread is a meeting between the book and a changed reader.

BOOK	FIRST READ	REREAD	WHAT CHANGED

Reading patterns I notice



Use the data only if it gives you something kind or useful.

I READ MORE WHEN

Time, access, environment, energy, accountability, season, format.

I PAUSE OR ABANDON BOOKS WHEN

Pacing, mood mismatch, pressure, content, attention, time, access.

MY TASTE SURPRISED ME WHEN

A genre, author, structure, topic, or format worked unexpectedly.

ONE ADJUSTMENT FOR NEXT SEASON

Make it small and observable.

PART FOUR

Reviews that sound like you

A review can be a feeling, an argument, a craft analysis, a recommendation, or all four.

INSIDE THIS PART

- Capture eight quick reviews
- Separate enjoyment from craft
- Make room for mixed reactions
- Use the reusable pack for full analysis



Quick Vibe Review 1



Capture the feeling while it is fresh. Use the reusable pack when a book deserves the full deep dive.

TITLE

AUTHOR

☐ 1 star

☐ 2 stars

☐ 3 stars

☐ 4 stars

☐ 5 stars

THE VIBE IN THREE WORDS

WHAT WORKED

WHAT DID NOT

FAVORITE CHARACTER, SCENE, IDEA, OR LINE

WHO I WOULD RECOMMEND IT TO

Quick Vibe Review 2



Capture the feeling while it is fresh. Use the reusable pack when a book deserves the full deep dive.

TITLE

AUTHOR

☐ 1 star

☐ 2 stars

☐ 3 stars

☐ 4 stars

☐ 5 stars

THE VIBE IN THREE WORDS

WHAT WORKED

WHAT DID NOT

FAVORITE CHARACTER, SCENE, IDEA, OR LINE

WHO I WOULD RECOMMEND IT TO

Quick Vibe Review 3



Capture the feeling while it is fresh. Use the reusable pack when a book deserves the full deep dive.

TITLE

AUTHOR

☐ 1 star

☐ 2 stars

☐ 3 stars

☐ 4 stars

☐ 5 stars

THE VIBE IN THREE WORDS

WHAT WORKED

WHAT DID NOT

FAVORITE CHARACTER, SCENE, IDEA, OR LINE

WHO I WOULD RECOMMEND IT TO

Quick Vibe Review 4



Capture the feeling while it is fresh. Use the reusable pack when a book deserves the full deep dive.

TITLE

AUTHOR

☐ 1 star

☐ 2 stars

☐ 3 stars

☐ 4 stars

☐ 5 stars

THE VIBE IN THREE WORDS

WHAT WORKED

WHAT DID NOT

FAVORITE CHARACTER, SCENE, IDEA, OR LINE

WHO I WOULD RECOMMEND IT TO

Quick Vibe Review 5



Capture the feeling while it is fresh. Use the reusable pack when a book deserves the full deep dive.

TITLE

AUTHOR

☐ 1 star

☐ 2 stars

☐ 3 stars

☐ 4 stars

☐ 5 stars

THE VIBE IN THREE WORDS

WHAT WORKED

WHAT DID NOT

FAVORITE CHARACTER, SCENE, IDEA, OR LINE

WHO I WOULD RECOMMEND IT TO

Quick Vibe Review 6



Capture the feeling while it is fresh. Use the reusable pack when a book deserves the full deep dive.

TITLE

AUTHOR

☐ 1 star

☐ 2 stars

☐ 3 stars

☐ 4 stars

☐ 5 stars

THE VIBE IN THREE WORDS

WHAT WORKED

WHAT DID NOT

FAVORITE CHARACTER, SCENE, IDEA, OR LINE

WHO I WOULD RECOMMEND IT TO

Quick Vibe Review 7



Capture the feeling while it is fresh. Use the reusable pack when a book deserves the full deep dive.

TITLE

AUTHOR

☐ 1 star

☐ 2 stars

☐ 3 stars

☐ 4 stars

☐ 5 stars

THE VIBE IN THREE WORDS

WHAT WORKED

WHAT DID NOT

FAVORITE CHARACTER, SCENE, IDEA, OR LINE

WHO I WOULD RECOMMEND IT TO

Quick Vibe Review 8



Capture the feeling while it is fresh. Use the reusable pack when a book deserves the full deep dive.

TITLE

AUTHOR

☐ 1 star

☐ 2 stars

☐ 3 stars

☐ 4 stars

☐ 5 stars

THE VIBE IN THREE WORDS

WHAT WORKED

WHAT DID NOT

FAVORITE CHARACTER, SCENE, IDEA, OR LINE

WHO I WOULD RECOMMEND IT TO

PART FIVE

Challenges without pressure

A challenge should open a door. You are allowed to skip the room.

INSIDE THIS PART

- Play reading bingo
- Travel through places and perspectives
- Explore genres and your own shelves
- Change every rule that stops being fun



Try: recommended by a friend, under 200 pages, translated, a debut, from your shelf, audiobook, reread, gorgeous cover, older than you, local author. Make the center square 'change my mind.'

A-Z Reading Challenge



Use titles, authors, characters, places, or a mix. Hard letters may live anywhere in the word.

LETTER	BOOK / AUTHOR	FINISHED	TINY NOTE

Read Around the World



Track setting, author connection, translation, and what you learned without reducing a culture to a checkbox.

PLACE	BOOK	AUTHOR / VOICE	CONNECTION / CONTEXT

Genre Explorer



Choose subgenres and forms you are genuinely curious about.

GENRE / FORM	BOOK	WHY THIS ONE	RESULT

Read My Own Shelf



Let the books already waiting compete with the algorithm.

BOOK	HOW LONG OWNED	WHY NOW	READ

The color-cover challenge



Build a visual rainbow, monochrome shelf, seasonal palette, or completely chaotic color story.

Sketch spines, list titles, paste tiny cover images you own permission to use, or color blocks. This is a visual game, not a requirement to buy matching books.

My custom challenge



Build a challenge around the reader you are, not the reader the internet rewards.

THE INVITATION

What do you want to discover, revisit, or make room for?

THE PROMPTS

Create 6-12 flexible prompts.

THE SUPPORTS

Library lists, friends, time, formats, accessibility, budget, content information.

THE EXIT RULE

When can you switch, skip, or stop without calling it failure?

PART SIX

Book club

The best discussion makes room for evidence, experience, disagreement, laughter, and changed minds.

INSIDE THIS PART

- Define the club's personality
- Nominate and choose books
- Plan four meetings
- Keep discussion welcoming and specific



Our club profile



A little structure protects the fun.

WHO WE ARE

Names, group, community, class, family, friends, or open membership.

WHAT WE LIKE TO READ

Genres, lengths, formats, content limits, and risks we want to take.

HOW WE CHOOSE

Vote, rotate, theme, host pick, library availability, price, accessibility.

OUR DISCUSSION AGREEMENTS

Spoilers, airtime, disagreement, privacy, attendance, food, and unfinished books.

Nomination Board



Collect enough information to choose fairly.

BOOK	NOMINATED BY	WHY	ACCESS	VOTE

Meeting 1



Plan lightly enough that the conversation can still surprise you.

BOOK + DATE + HOST

Include format and location or link.

OPENING REACTION

What feeling or question should start the room?

DISCUSSION NOTES

Arguments, evidence, tensions, favorite moments, disagreements.

NEXT BOOK + FOLLOW-UP

Decisions, recommendations, unfinished questions.

Meeting 2



Plan lightly enough that the conversation can still surprise you.

BOOK + DATE + HOST

Include format and location or link.

OPENING REACTION

What feeling or question should start the room?

DISCUSSION NOTES

Arguments, evidence, tensions, favorite moments, disagreements.

NEXT BOOK + FOLLOW-UP

Decisions, recommendations, unfinished questions.

Meeting 3



Plan lightly enough that the conversation can still surprise you.

BOOK + DATE + HOST

Include format and location or link.

OPENING REACTION

What feeling or question should start the room?

DISCUSSION NOTES

Arguments, evidence, tensions, favorite moments, disagreements.

NEXT BOOK + FOLLOW-UP

Decisions, recommendations, unfinished questions.

Meeting 4



Plan lightly enough that the conversation can still surprise you.

BOOK + DATE + HOST

Include format and location or link.

OPENING REACTION

What feeling or question should start the room?

DISCUSSION NOTES

Arguments, evidence, tensions, favorite moments, disagreements.

NEXT BOOK + FOLLOW-UP

Decisions, recommendations, unfinished questions.

Discussion that goes somewhere



Questions work best when they invite evidence and more than one defensible answer.

A CRAFT QUESTION

How did structure, voice, setting, pacing, or image create the effect?

A CHARACTER OR POWER QUESTION

Who gets agency, sympathy, knowledge, safety, or the final word?

A THEME QUESTION

What tension does the book explore without neatly solving?

A PERSONAL CONNECTION WITH BOUNDARIES

What can readers share without being required to disclose private experience?

PART SEVEN

Joy, taste + bookish chaos

Books can be art, argument, comfort, obsession, decoration, community, and delight.

INSIDE THIS PART

- Design your dream library and reading nook
- Invite fictional guests to dinner
- Name favorites, red flags, and pet peeves
- Close the year with the stories that remain



My dream library



No budget, square footage, or physics required.

Add rolling ladders, tiny nooks, dramatic windows, accessibility, snacks, children's shelves, locked rare books, plants, cats, secret doors, and exactly the lighting you want.

The perfect reading nook



Design for your real sensory needs and your fantasy aesthetic.

Include seating, light, temperature, sound, storage, charging, drinks, blankets, mobility, privacy, and what is definitely not allowed nearby.

My fictional dinner party



Curate the chemistry, not just the guest list.

THE GUESTS

Choose 4-8 characters, authors as public figures, or narrators.

THE SEATING CHART

Who must sit together? Who needs distance?

THE MENU + SETTING

Let the books inspire atmosphere without requiring historical accuracy.

THE CONVERSATION THAT CHANGES EVERYTHING

What question causes the table to go silent?

Characters in my life



Fictional relationships are serious business.

WE COULD BE FRIENDS

- ☐ The loyal one
- ☐ The funny one
- ☐ The competent one
- ☐ The soft one
- ☐ The chaotic one
- ☐ The truth teller

I WOULD NOT TRUST

- ☐ The charming liar
- ☐ The secret keeper
- ☐ The 'for your own good' one
- ☐ The power collector
- ☐ The unreliable genius
- ☐ The obvious villain I still love reading

NAMES + EVIDENCE

Name the characters and the exact scene, choice, or pattern that earned the placement.

Books I wish I could read again for the first time

First reads cannot be recreated, but the memory of discovery can be kept.

THE BOOK

Title and author.

THE MOMENT I KNEW

A scene, line, turn, feeling, or realization - paraphrase if you are sharing publicly.

WHO I WAS THEN

What season of life met the book?

WHAT I CARRY NOW

The part that survived familiarity.

Bookish pet peeves + red flags



Taste is personal. Be dramatic responsibly.

A TROPE THAT EXHAUSTS ME

What makes it fail - and has any book made it work?

A CRAFT HABIT I NOTICE IMMEDIATELY

Pacing, exposition, dialogue, description, viewpoint, endings.

A READER-CULTURE RED FLAG

Gatekeeping, shaming formats, performative totals, harassment, piracy, or spoiler behavior.

MY HARMLESSLY PETTY OPINION

A safe place for the thing that simply annoys you.

Books for every season of me



Build a personal recommendation shelf by feeling and life chapter.

FOR COMFORT

What feels steady or familiar?

FOR COURAGE

What makes you feel capable, understood, or willing?

FOR GRIEF OR CHANGE

What can sit beside complexity without flattening it?

FOR JOY

What reliably returns sparkle?

My reading year in review



The books are numbers only if you want them to be. The meaning is the better ending.

THE FAVORITES

Book, character, setting, line, cover, narrator, new author.

THE SURPRISES

Biggest delight, disappointment, risk, DNF, changed opinion.

WHAT THE YEAR TAUGHT ME ABOUT MY TASTE

Patterns, boundaries, access, moods, communities, and craft.

WHAT I WANT NEXT YEAR

One invitation, not twenty obligations.

A letter to my future reading self



Close the journal without closing the library.

The next book does not have to improve you. It is allowed to delight you, disturb you, teach you, accompany you, or simply pass the time.

REMEMBER

What do you never want metrics, trends, school, or the internet to make you forget?

KEEP SEEKING

What voices, feelings, questions, craft, and forms deserve more room?

PERMISSION FOR THE NEXT CHAPTER

Finish: You are allowed to...